Inference-time proofreader guidance

Can the released proofreader improve complete contact maps by changing sampling, looking ahead, maintaining several prefixes, repairing errors, or combining larger independent rollout pools?

Frozen generator: exp277 step 266344. Frozen proofreader: exp356 step 18000.
Implementation and GPU validation are in progress; no guided-policy result yet.

Complete ordinary-pool pilot

On 32 validation structures, sum-q R-precision increases from 0.5792 with eight rollouts to 0.5993 with 128. The paired gain is 0.0200, with 95% group-bootstrap interval 0.0050–0.0329. Long-range R-precision rises from 0.5537 to 0.5806.

Candidate coverage grows from 0.7765 to 0.9509. At 128 rollouts, frequency alone slightly exceeds sum-q: all-contact R-precision 0.6040, long-range 0.5864. Most remaining error is ranking error despite the much larger candidate pool.

Confidence tie-breaking and predicted-F1 vote weighting were added as exploratory validation tests. Their tiny gains over frequency have intervals including zero.

First result: aggregation baseline

On existing validation rollouts, sum q remains strongest among five simple aggregators: all-contact R-precision 0.5315; long-range R-precision 0.5046. Frequency gives 0.5167 and 0.4877 respectively. Mean q alone gives 0.4895.

With up to eight rollouts, the pool contains about 75% of native contacts. This separates missing-contact generation from ranking errors. Oracle pool coverage is an upper bound, not the performance of an inference method.

Frozen pilot and execution

32 validation proteins from distinct homology groups span 33–937 residues. Compare top-percentile gates, soft weighting, lookahead, population search and one-pass repair, plus ordinary vLLM pools of 8, 32 and 128 rollouts.

Measure full-universe AP, all/long-range R-precision and complete search cost. Select policies on validation, then lock a reserved-test confirmation plan. Jobs use co-located CoreWeave H100s and resumable per-rollout artifacts.

Execution recovery

An eight-H100 RNO worker was preempted repeatedly. Iris failure-retry limits do not limit preemption retries, so the worker repeated its shared model transfer and lost local progress. It was canceled on detection; the incident is recorded.

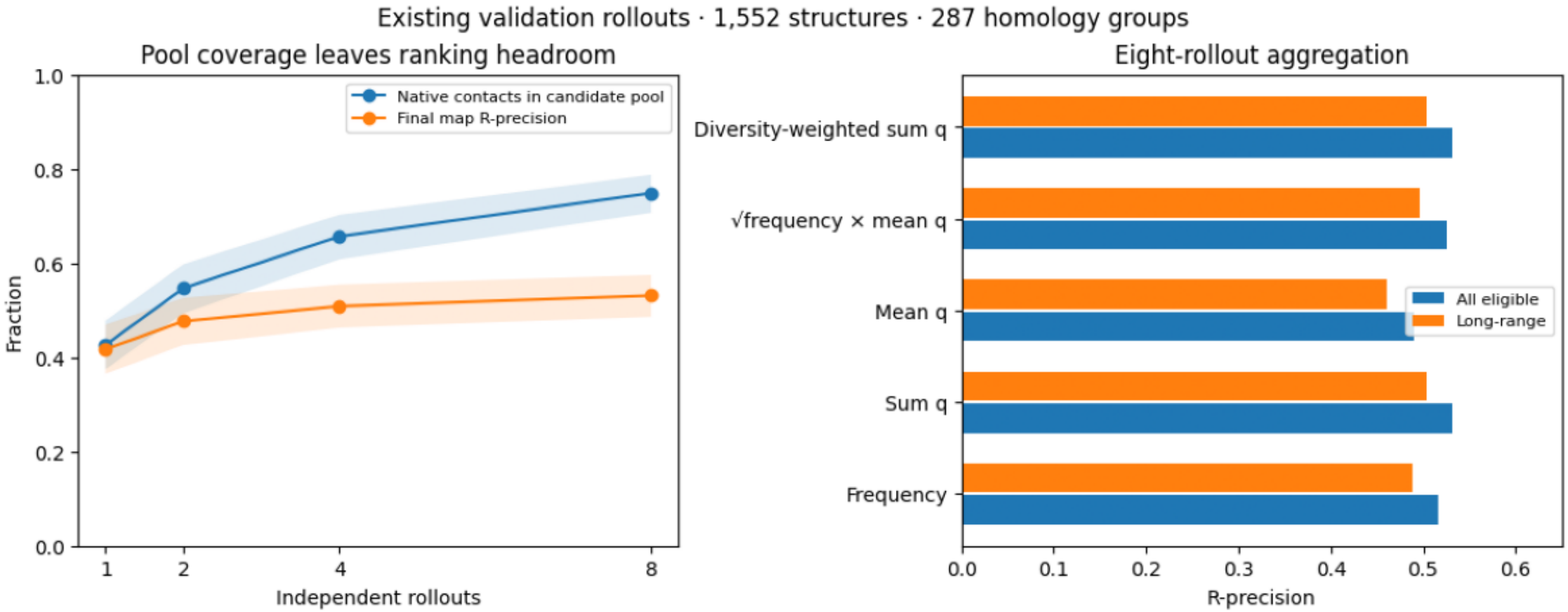
Twelve colocated H100 workers now resume the original source snapshots directly from durable S3 trajectories. A complete guided comparison is still pending. Ordinary baselines are queued for 1,375 structures from 255 validation groups outside the pilot. The reserved test set has not been read for this campaign.

Numerical validation

All frozen backbone tensors match the generator exactly. CPU cache tests agree with full forward passes. The first H100 smoke caught BF16 incremental/full-pass drift of up to 0.02394 in one contact probability. FP32 cached search passes on three real proteins, with maximum error 0.00000358. Final maps use the released BF16 full-pass reader for comparison.

existing_validation.png

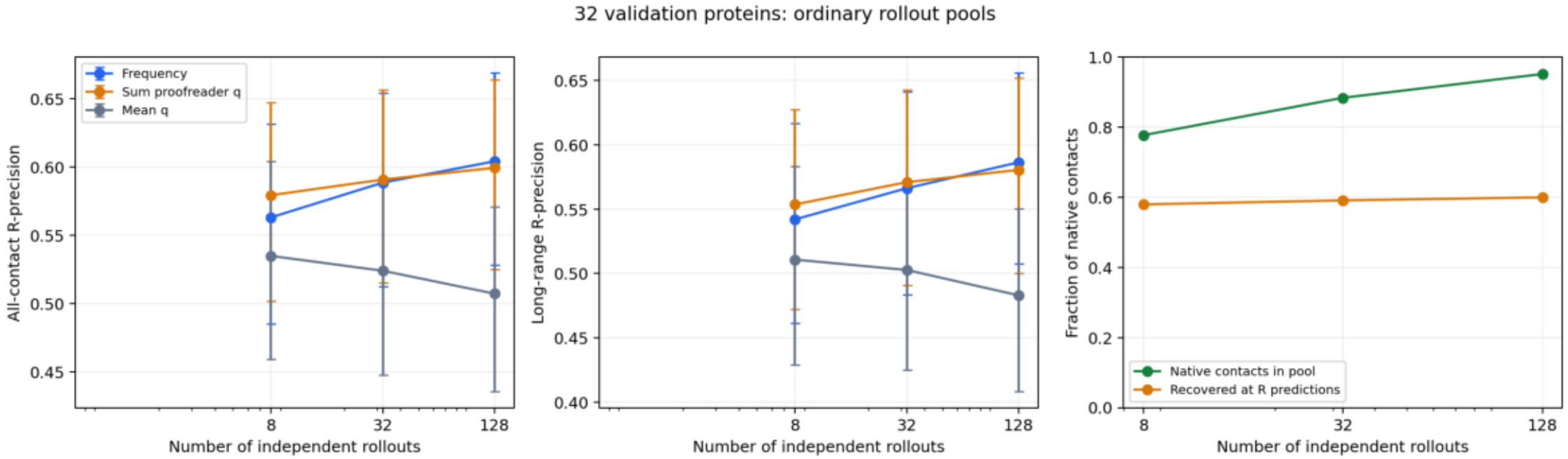
Validation-only reanalysis. Bands resample homology groups (95% intervals). Oracle coverage uses labels only to bound achievable recall. The small number of structures with fewer than eight usable rollouts retains all available samples. Long-range means separation ≥24.




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$ plot_existing.py
```

pilot_pool.png

Mean over the same validation structures. Error bars are 95% homology-group bootstrap intervals. Oracle coverage measures whether a native contact was proposed; it is not an attainable ranking result. Long-range means sequence separation at least 24. No test-set results appear here.




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$ plot_pools.py --data experiments/exp368_evals_proofreader_guided_contact_maps/data/pilot_pool --out experiments/exp368_evals_proofreader_guided_contact_maps/plots/pilot_pool.png
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